that it is the sort of thing that should be uncontroversially knowable. ***Dharmakirti*** and other Buddhists focus on the problems of disentangling the soul from the personality and its experiences. They reason that it is never known, although it is described as the sort of thing that is knowable. This non-apprehension proves its non-existence.

The same pattern of reasoning is applied to the notion of Prime Matter (*prakriti*), which is supposed by ***Samkhyas*** and ***Vedantins*** to be the ultimate source and underlying cause of all material products.

But the fact that we do not see supernatural entities, such as ghosts, does not prove that they do not exist because they are by nature inaccessible to normal perception. This applies to anything inaccessible to perception by virtue of space, time or nature. This is applied in arguments about the existence of other minds. From the fact that we do not perceive them it does not follow that they do not exist.

See ***Anupalabdhi-hetu***

Further reading: Kajiyama 1998; Tillemans 1999; Wood 1991

Duhkha (suffering, frustration, unsatisfactoriness): agreed by almost everyone to characterise transmigratory existence (***samsara***) or the series of embodied lives in the here and now. It is one of the basic truths discovered by the Buddha that everything is *duhkha*, impermanent and devoid of unchanging identity (***anatta***). This means more than the fact that life is sometimes sad and that toothache is unpleasant. It is obvious that not all experiences are painful. Rather, it expresses the view that human projects, however noble their aspirations, end in failure and disappointment. It is the outlook of the person who has examined all the sources of consolation and found them wanting. Buddhism says one of our basic problems is a selfish thirst